

Greek And Latin

You might have seen some characters in MS Word getting printed out as little square boxes—such characters include Greek symbols and such. This happens on printers that don't support Unicode characters. Here's a hack to make those gammas and lambdas print out properly.

Navigate to:

HCU\Software\Microsoft\Office\11.0\Word\Options

(Here, the "11.0" is for Office 2003; for Office XP and Office 2000, it's 10.0 and 9.0 respectively.)

Create a new String value (or modify the existing value) called **NoWideTextPrinting**. Set it to **1** to enable the interesting characters. The default is **0**.

When you use this setting, print quality may be lower than when you have direct Unicode support.

If You Like Four-Digit Dates

Excel, like everything pre-2000, shows dates in the two-digit format. Many people use four digits for the year these days, and you can force Excel to do the same.

Navigate to:

HCU\Software\Microsoft\Office\11.0\Excel\Options

(Here, the "11.0" is for Office 2003; for Office XP and Office 2000, it's 10.0 and 9.0 respectively.)

Create a new DWORD value (or modify it if it's already there) called **EnableFourDigitYearDisplay**. Set it to **1** for four digits, and to **0** for two digits.

The change should be effective immediately; if it's not, restart Windows.